

Francis William Touola Meda

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SUMMARY

Academic researcher with a PhD in Political Science and a strong focus on political institutions, bureaucracy, and governance. Experienced in designing and managing field and survey research, training and supervising enumerators, and conducting rigorous data cleaning and analysis using R and Stata.

WORK EXPERIENCE

12/2025 – Present	Visiting Assistant Professor African School of Economics	Abuja, Nigeria
	• Teach Introductory and Intermediate Microeconomics. • Teach Introduction to International Politics. • Teach Foundations of Comparative Politics and Political Economy.	
05/2024 – 06/2025	Postdoctoral Research Fellow (Mercury Project: Cote d'Ivoire, Senegal, Zimbabwe & Malawi) University of California, Berkeley, at Evidence in Governance and Politics	California, USA
	• Led and organized training programs for enumerators. • Contributed to the Training Team during EGAP's Learning Days initiative. • Oversaw follow-up data collection, performed data cleaning, and analysis.	
09/2020 – 05/2024	Teaching Assistant New York University (NYU)	New York, USA
	• Taught International Politics (Undergraduate Level). • Taught Quantitative Methods Analysis (Graduate Level).	
01/2017 – 06/2017	Research Assistant (Youth Employment Project: Benin) World Bank & Institute for Empirical Research in Political Economy	Cotonou, Benin
	• Coordinated pilot exercises, trained, and supervised field survey teams. • Assisted with data cleaning and analysis • Conducted cost analysis for the cost-effectiveness study.	
07/2016 – 12/2016	Research Assistant (Impact evaluation of the promotion of girls' education in Benin) 3ie & Institute for Empirical Research in Political Economy	Cotonou, Benin
	• Collaborated with directors of secondary schools in Northern Benin. • Oversaw data collection across 9 departments in Northern Benin.	

EDUCATION

09/2017 – 05/2024	New York University (NYU) PhD, Political Science Political Economy	New York, USA
05/2021 – 09/2022	New York University Master's, Political Science	New York, USA

09/2014 – 06/2016	African School of Economics (ASE) Master's, Mathematics, Economics, and Statistics	Cotonou, Benin
09/2012 – 06/2014	École Normale Supérieure of Yaoundé I (ENS) High School Teaching Degree, Mathematics	Yaounde, Cameroon
09/2007 – 06/2010	University of Dschang Bachelor's, Applied Mathematics and Computer Science	Dschang, Cameroon

RESEARCH

Autocratic Rule and Economic Performance: Reframing the Loyalty-Competence Trade-off (JMP)	Submitted
Advice and Political Accountability	Submitted
Public-Sector Wages and Corruption: The Role of Public Service Motivation	Working paper
Empowering the People: How to Promote Responsiveness to the Poor?	Working paper
• Joint with Antonella Bandiera, Dogil Lee & Cyrus Samii	

GRANTS/HONORS/AWARDS/FELLOWSHIPS

2026 – Present	* PI, STEG's 6th Larger Research Grants (£ 50,000)
2022 – 2022	* GSAS Dean's Conference Fund, NYU (\$ 500)
2023 – 2023	* Political Science Department Conference Grant, NYU (\$ 1000)
2017 – 2024	* MacCracken Fellowship, NYU (\$ 70,715/year)
2016 – 2017	* Pre-Doctoral Fellowship, ASE (CFA 2,880,000)
2014 – 2016	* African Centre of Excellence Scholarships, ASE (\$7,000/year)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Kiel - CEPR African Economic Development Conference (AEDC) (2024,2025); American Political Science Association Conference (APSA, 2023); Africa Meeting of the Econometric Society (AFES, 2023); Midwest Political Science Association Conference (MPSA, 2023); Political Science Political Economy Conference, London School of Economics (2022); Virtual Formal Theory Workshop, Formal Theory Society (2023); Political Economy Workshop, New York University (2022); Kuznets Mini-Conference, Yale University (2022); Comparative Politics Seminar, New York University (2021,2022,2023).

SKILLS

Formal Theory	Political Institutions
Bureaucracy	Governance
Applied economics	causal inference surveys
RCTs	Data collection

Data analysis

STATA

R

SurveyCTO

LANGUAGES

French (Native speaker)

English (Fluent)

INTERESTS

Soccer,

Basketball,

Tennis, Hiking

REFERENCES

Arturas Rozenas

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Cyrus Samii

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